Toronto Metropolitan University – Toronto
Department of Economics
350 Victoria Street,
Toronto, ON M5B 2K3
Canada

Placement Director:
Keyvan Eslami
(416) 979-5000
k.eslami@torontomu.ca

Placement Coordinator:
Karen Fajardo
kfajardo@torontomu.ca

Curriculum Vitae
Spring 2026

Amin Shirazian

link to latest version

Personal Data

Address	*Contact Information*
Department of Economics	Cell: (647) 686–9324
Toronto Metropolitan University	Email: amin.shirazian.work@gmail.com
350 Victoria Street, Toronto, ON M5B 2K3	Website: aminshz.github.io/my-website
	LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/amin-shirazian

Citizenship: Iran / Canada (S1 Visa, Open Work Permit & Study Permit)

Major Fields of Concentration

Macroeconomics, Heterogeneous-Agent Models, Policy Analysis, Health Economics

Education

Degree	*Field*	*Institution*	*Year*
Ph.D. (GPA: 4.17/4.33)	Economics	Toronto Metropolitan University	2026
M.A. (GPA: 4.00/4.33)	Economics	Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies	2020
B.A. (GPA: 3.14/4.33)	Economics	Tehran University	2018

Dissertation:
Title: *"Essays on Health Shocks and Other Precautionary Saving Motives"*
Advisor: Professor Keyvan Eslami
Expected Completion: Summer 2026

References

Keyvan Eslami
Department of Economics
Toronto Metropolitan University
k.eslami@torontomu.ca

Claustre Bajona
Department of Economics
Toronto Metropolitan University
cbajona@torontomu.ca

Kevin Fawcett
Department of Economics
Toronto Metropolitan University
fawcettk@torontomu.ca

Haomiao Yu
Department of Economics
Toronto Metropolitan University
haomiao@torontomu.ca

Honors and Awards

2017–2026	Full Graduate Scholarship: Ph.D. / M.A.
2022–2023	Graduate Assistant Recognition Award, Toronto Metropolitan University
2021	Top Second-Year PhD Student, Toronto Metropolitan University

Teaching Experience

Summer 2024 – Present	**Contract Lecturer**, Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University. Taught *Intermediate Macroeconomics I* (×3), *Introductory Macroeconomics*, *Economic Issues in Globalization* (×2)
January 2021 – Present	**Teaching Assistant**, Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University. Taught *Adv. Macroeconomics I*, *Mathematical Economics*, *Advanced Microeconomics II*; led PhD tutorials
January 2018 – January 2020	**Teaching Assistant**, Tehran Institute for Advanced Studies / Khatam University. Taught *Advanced Macroeconomics*, *Advanced Financial Economics*; led MA tutorials

Research Experience

2022–Present	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Toronto Metropolitan University
Summer 2023	Research Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Toronto
2018–2020	Research Assistant, TeIAS, Tehran, Iran (Prof. Hagh-Panah)

Professional Experience

2023–2024	*VP Education*, Economics Graduate Students Association, Toronto Metropolitan University
2022–2023	*VP Communication*, Economics Graduate Students Association, Toronto Metropolitan University
2021–2022	*President*, Economics Graduate Students Association, Toronto Metropolitan University
2021–2022	*Director*, Graduate Students Union, Toronto Metropolitan University
2014–2015	*Director*, Students Union, University of Tehran, Faculty of Economics

Papers

- Shirazian, A. *"Marginal Utility Shocks and the Precautionary Saving Puzzle"*, Job Market Paper (pdf).
- Shirazian, A. *"Means-Tested Insurance and Pareto-Tailed Wealth Distribution"* (pdf).
- Shirazian, A. *"Online Innovation, Market Entry and Competition in Remote Indigenous Communities"*, with Yasir Mudathir and Nicholas Li, *in progress*.
- Shirazian, A. *"Women Live Longer: Retirement Saving Puzzle"*, Masters Thesis.

Computer Skills

Statistical / data: Stata, R, Python (Selenium, BeautifulSoup) · **Computational:** MATLAB, C++ · **Other:** LaTeX, Git, HTML/CSS

Languages

English (fluent), Persian (native)

Abstracts

Marginal Utility Shocks and the Precautionary Saving Puzzle Job Market Paper

This paper asks whether precautionary saving induced by health shocks helps explain saving at the top of the wealth distribution. Using the Health and Retirement Study, it documents that pre-retirement couples in the top wealth decile save about $1.1 million over two years, whereas standard income-fluctuation models predict roughly $2 million of dissaving. It then shows that a luxury-health framework, in which survival remains valuable at all wealth levels, can resolve this puzzle. The paper embeds this framework in an income-fluctuation model and derives a sufficient condition under which the precautionary saving motive remains active at arbitrarily high wealth. Given that saving remains positive beyond this threshold and mortality generates random separation across cohorts, it proves that the induced stationary wealth distribution has Pareto tails, the first such result from precautionary saving alone. After estimating the health production function and calibrating the model, the paper shows that the mechanism predicts saving of $121,960 against $1.1 million observed in the top decile, accounting for roughly 11 percent of observed top-decile saving, whereas the benchmark model predicts dissaving.

Means-Tested Insurance and Pareto-Tailed Wealth Distribution In Progress

This paper imputes total medical spending for the Health and Retirement Survey (HRS) using the Medical Expenditure Survey (MEPS) and discusses moment consistency of the imputed health expenditure. The main theorem proves that, under classical assumptions, OLS estimates remain consistent when using the imputed dependent variable.

Women Live Longer: Retirement Saving Puzzle MA Thesis

This paper presents an explanation to the excess sensitivity of consumption to the drop in income around retirement, known as the "retirement saving puzzle." We confirm this empirical puzzle also prevails among Iranian families. That is, an unpredicted drop occurs in households' non-durable expenditures around the age of 65, which cannot be resolved even by decomposing household heads according to their labor status. Then, by taking into account the diversity in the gender composition of cohorts, we demonstrate that the gap between predicted and actual non-durable expenditures is no longer apparent.